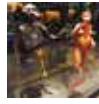




Ads mid videos

Facebook wants to start showing ads in its videos and share 55 percent of sales with publishers. <http://digit.in/FBadsMid>



Open sourcing Lucy

Digital model of the world's most famous fossil australopithecine, Lucy, is now available for researchers for download. <http://digit.in/LucyFossil>

Smart SoHo

low probability of success. On the other hand, there are so many huge crowd-funded campaigns that started from nothing. The important thing to figure out if crowdfunding works is to understand what works in crowdfunding. Because when it works - it works big.

The right product for the right market

Theoretically any product and idea can have a kickstarter. But in practice, there are certain categories that work better. In fact, one could go as far as saying that these categories have put crowdfunding on the map. Crowdfunding campaigns for gadgets (of almost any kind), videogames and movies work better than other categories. Don't believe us? Head to the Kickstarter Discover section and sort the projects by 'Most Funded', your screen will be littered by projects from the three areas mentioned above. As a comparison, filter the projects by location to India and see the same screen be filled with similar projects, with just the number of backers dropping twenty-fold.

Don't get us wrong, we aren't saying that crowdfunding in India isn't possible. Take a look at Wishberry which has raised about 10cr across 350 projects to accomplish a success rate of 70% (that is 7 in 10 projects reaching their goals). Anshulika



Anshulika Dubey, Co-Founder and COO at Wishberry

Dubey, Co-Founder and COO at Wishberry effectively explains the situation, "As of now, there have been only glimpses of tech innovations in India, majorly in the form of mobile applications and student projects. However, crowdfunding has been able to add

immense value in the Indian creative space. Three films - Kothanodi, Goonga Pehelwan and Breaking Free, which crowdfunded on Wishberry went on to win the National Award."

But there are mainly two problems in the Indian crowdfunding scenario - the lack of trust in putting your money behind a stranger's vision and the lack of an innovative culture to begin with. Mr. Satish Kataria, Managing Director, Catapoolt, commenting on the state of crowdfunding in India addresses this issue, "There are some innovations from India which have successfully used crowdfunding. Exploride from Cochin, CarIQ from Pune are some such innovations. But having said that - the quantum of product innovations in India is still far less than what is happening in international markets. Kickstarter, for example, lists almost 20 new innovations (in consumer segment) everyday. This is one challenge that we in India are attempting to address.

Plan... and then plan some more

Even if you've finalised your idea and have a prototype ready, don't start your crowdfunding page just yet. There are quite a few things that you need to ensure so that your page doesn't disappear in the crowd (pun intended). It might vary from project to project but it is undeniable that simply building a product and putting it out there won't work. Speaking about what comprises a potentially successful crowdfunding campaign, Varun Sheth- CEO and Founder of Ketto shared a few pointers.

- It should have a brilliant story. You can't expect people to chip in if you can't do justice in explaining the cause you're raising funds for, right? Of course, using pictures and videos just adds more value to your story.
- You should have a promotion plan in place. We're facilitators but the real talking of the fundraiser will be done by the campaigner - you're the voice of your cause. Having a plan is indispensable.
- You should know which platforms

you're going to use to spread the word and who you can approach to amplify the story.

- Thanking your supporters and constantly responding to their queries/concerns increases the possibility of them spreading the word about your fundraiser. It should never be ignored. So you should probably have dedicated resources for doing this.



Varun Sheth- CEO and Founder of Ketto

As mentioned, there are a few common things you'll notice in most of the successful campaigns like effective videos, product shots etc that need to be worked on in the planning period. Alongside, it is equally important to build an audience - talk about your product, spread the word among friends and family and DEFINITELY have a website.

Hold on a sec.. Why are we doing this

So, as we can see, crowdfunding today has its own set of problems and it plays completely by its own rules. And looking at those rules, it might seem like quite a task if you don't have the benefits in mind. So why go for it? Why is it becoming more popular as each year goes by? As Varun puts it, "With every year, crowdfunding is becoming popular among entrepreneurs mainly because it's a great way to 'test the waters' before you actually go big and launch the product/service. You understand your idea's worth and where it stands in the industry. It's actually the crowd telling you what's working and what needs to be weeded out - that's what any entrepreneur wants. So if